

NARWC Database — Update Since July 19

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What's changed

Since the July 19 walkthrough:

- Five new data sources are wired up: CCS aerial, CCS vessel, CCS opportunistic sightings, NEAQ vessel, and NEAQ aerial surveys can now all be run through the system.
- One process now, not two. Importing historical data and importing new surveys used to be separate systems; they're now the same steps. Nothing changes in how you use it day to day.
- Fewer false-alarm errors. Two validation quirks were fixed — species codes now auto-fill their taxonomic category where possible, and stray GPS button-presses with no species logged are no longer flagged as “missing species.”
- Folder layout cleanup. The data folder was reorganized for consistency. This is why you'll need to run the one-time script below.

Three open questions for you/Bob, no rush, not blocking anything:

1. Tow Boat US(A) charter platform code (CCS). The cover sheet for 2023 `Vessel/TB032223.csv` (paired with the “Habitat 2023 Season” cover sheet — there's no data file under that name) lists three possible codes: 107 (R/V Shearwater), 583 (merchant vessel), or 573 (towboat/similar). Which one actually applies?
2. NEA vs. CWI as the data source. Every Bay of Fundy (Fundy*) and Gulf of St. Lawrence (GSL*) file from the NEAQ & CWI vessel program currently reads `DDSOURCE=NEA`, even though the data was physically collected by CWI (Canadian Whale Institute) as part of that joint program. A CWI code already exists in the lookup table but isn't used anywhere in these files. Is NEA intentional (NEAQ as the data-submission steward for the joint program), or should some/all of these be CWI instead?
3. Two boats sharing one platform code. Fundy's “Scratcher” and GSL's “FRC Charlie” — two different small boats — are both currently coded `PLATFORM=572`, which is actually the lookup table's entry for the unrelated “Campobello Whale Rescue Boat.” Neither has its own platform code. Should we add dedicated codes for them, or is 572 an acceptable generic stand-in for now?

Until these are resolved, files affected by them are deliberately left without a `DDSOURCE/PLATFORM` default, so they'll show up flagged rather than silently guessed. Full detail (if you want it) is in `PROJECT_STATUS.md` §8.7 and `CHANGELOG.md`.

What to do

1. Pull the latest **main** branch.
2. Open MATLAB and run **startup**, as always.
3. Run the one-time folder cleanup (safe, reversible, fine to re-run):

```
reorganize_data_folder()           % dry run – shows what it would move, moves nothing
reorganize_data_folder('Apply', true) % actually moves the files
```

Nothing gets deleted — it only relocates files into the new folder names. Review the dry-run output first; if anything looks off, stop and ask.

That's it — your existing workflow is unchanged otherwise. The five new parsers are just available next time files come in from those sources.

Please do this before you leave on August 1 if you get a chance, so everything's in sync when you're back.